



82% have faith in India's electoral system

Which party do you think is best suited to rule the country?



50%

69 per cent in Kolkata and 68 per cent in Chennai prefer the Congress



44%

87 per cent in Ahmedabad and 59 per cent in Mumbai are in BJP's favour

30 per cent think that politicians are doing a good job, the highest being in Mumbai at 64 per cent. Only 21 per cent believe that they are bad.

89% say that a candidate's background information should be made available to a voter

While 87 per cent in Chennai say no to politics as a profession, 70 per cent of Mumbai's youth are willing to join it.

Methodology

The INDIA TODAY-Synovate Youth and Politics Survey 2009 was conducted between January 14 and 22 in eight cities: Delhi, Mumbai, Kolkata, Chennai, Ahmedabad, Lucknow, Kochi and Indore. The methodology adopted was quantitative and the interviews were conducted either face-to-face or via telephone. The questionnaire was semi-structured. The target groups comprised men and women in the age group of 18 to 35, belonging to SEC A and B households. All respondents were randomly polled and 200 respondents were interviewed in every city.

tomorrow. The other, though immensely popular and always indulged, has already retired from active politics. The party's prime ministerial candidate—a politician of exceptional durability—fares badly in the survey (with 8 per cent at the seventh position, below Rahul, Sonia, Manmohan and Vajpayee.) And in popularity, he is at a dismal ninth. This must be especially saddening for Advani as he is desperately trying to reach out to the youth. Maybe it is not just ideology but biology too that matters in politics. India is young but our leadership is not: the prime minister is 76 and his challenger is 81. This is at a time when the leader of the other great democracy is just a 47-year-old who talks like a Churchill and writes like a novelist. In the Age of Obama, India is suffering from political senescence. When change is no longer a cliché but a history-making invocation, we are steeped in our dead certainties. When concepts like experience and wisdom are no longer revered in the battlefield, we seem to be the last country for the old.

The voice of the youth is a rejoinder as well as a rejection. They have said no to the official choices of both the Congress and BJP. What the Big Two of Indian politics project is not what the youth perceive. Visibility or volubility is not the criterion for choosing the leader India needs. The youth want dignity and decency in politics. Still, what they want is more than a republic of good men. They say gods or ideology can't change India. The performer alone can. Let the doer be the ruler. The judgement is harsh, and it punctures the fantasies of many venerable souls. Now let's watch who will be afraid of young India. ■